

Antarctica

The South Pole lies on a huge ice cap that sits on top of the frozen continent of Antarctica. In places the ice is more than 15,700ft (4,800m) thick, making it, on average, the world's highest continent. In 1959 the Antarctic Treaty set aside all territorial claims, preserving the continent for scientific research.

Scientific research

There are more than 40 permanent and 100 temporary research stations in Antarctica. In 1985, British scientists using weather balloons discovered a hole in the ozone layer, directly above this unique continent.

WEDDELL SEA

TO SOUTH AMERICA

TO AFRICA

SOUTHERN OCEAN

DAVIS SEA

TO AUSTRALIA

ROSS SEA

SOUTHERN OCEAN

AMUNDSEN SEA

BELLINGSHAUSEN SEA

SCOTIA SEA

Ronne ice shelf

Larsen ice shelf

Palmer Land

WEST ANTARCTICA

Marie Byrd Land

Ross Ice Shelf

Victoria Land

George V Land

Wilkes Land

Wilhelm II Land

Princess Elizabeth Land

Mac. Robertson Land

Kemp Land

Enderby Land

Dronning Maud Land

Coats Land

Did you bring a coat?

ANTARCTICA

SOUTH POLE

Transantarctic Mountains

Antarctic wildlife

Large colonies of seabirds live in Antarctica, including the king penguin and other birds that are unique to the continent and breed only here. The seas around its shores are rich in fish, seals, and whales.

Km 0 100 200 300 400 500
Miles 0 100 200 300 400 500